ABOUT US

OUR DOCTRINE AND POLICY

GARDEN CITY CHURCH
Version 1.1

INTRODUCTION

Garden City Church is a place where you will meet Jesus, and engage in life-giving community. We believe in creating a genuine space for you and your family to have an authentic encounter with Jesus Christ, discover your gifts and use them for God's glory.

ABOUT

We are a church rooted and guided by the Bible, with a Pentecostal/Charismatic expression. Our faith in Jesus moves us to follow His teachings and experience a transformed life in the here and now.

OUR APPROACH:

We embrace people as they are with the same grace we have received, recognizing that God doesn't leave us unchanged. He is working within each person who turns to Christ, to transform us into HIS image - to look more and more like Jesus. We're here to love people into a life defined by faith and founded in God’s word - to live the life and tell the story. To ensure clarity within this document, we establish a clear distinction between "doctrine" and "policy." Doctrine represents our best interpretation of the Bible as God's infallible and inspired word. It is derived solely from this principle and remains unaffected by personal preferences or opinions. On the other hand, policy, while still rooted in Scripture, is flexible and adaptable to what we discern to be most effective for our church's circumstances. The purpose of this document is to promote clarity and unity by defining the doctrines and policies that we collectively uphold as a unified church body.

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All scripture is referenced from the NASB translation unless otherwise noted

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WHO WE ARE

DISTINCTIVES

1. **BIBLE-DRIVEN FOUNDATION:**
Our church is firmly grounded in the Bible as the inspired and infallible Word of God. Every aspect of our teaching, worship, and community life is rooted in biblical principles.

2. **SALVATION THROUGH FAITH IN JESUS:**
We believe that salvation is exclusively attained through faith in Jesus Christ. His death and resurrection provide the only means for reconciliation between God and humanity.

3. **COOPERATIVE FELLOWSHIP OF THE ASSEMBLIES OF GOD:**
As a member of the Assemblies of God fellowship, we are part of a larger cooperative network of churches committed to spreading the Gospel and advancing the Kingdom of God.

4. **NO LOCAL CHURCH MEMBERSHIP:**
Unlike traditional models, we do not require formal membership to participate fully in our church community. Instead, we welcome all who seek to worship and grow in their faith with us.

5. **PASTOR-LED WITH BOARD OVERSIGHT:**
While our church is pastor-led, we also value accountability and oversight through a dedicated board. This ensures balanced leadership and decision-making within our congregation.

6. **BALANCING GIFTS OF THE SPIRIT WITH ORDER:**
We embrace the gifts of the Spirit as described in the Bible, while also emphasizing the importance of maintaining order and decency in our worship and gatherings.

7. **MAJORING ON MAJORS, MINORING ON MINORS:**
Our approach to theology and doctrine prioritizes essential truths while allowing for diversity in secondary beliefs. We focus on the core tenets of our faith while respecting differences in interpretation on lesser issues.

VISION AND MISSION

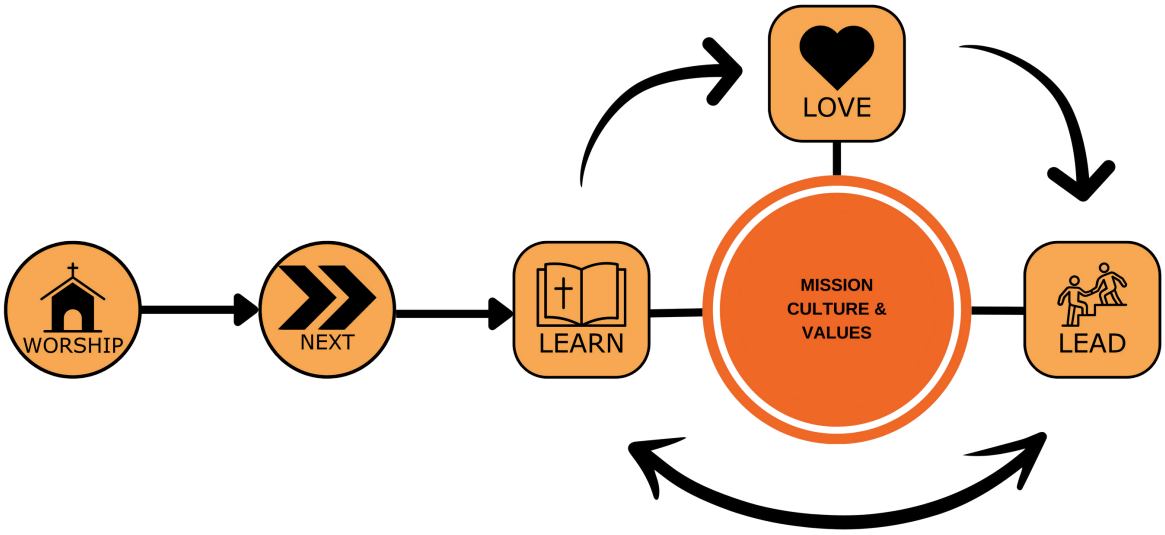
Mission: To know Christ and make Him known in our city and in every nation.
And He said to them, “Go into all the world and proclaim the gospel to the whole creation. Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned.” - Mark 16:15-16

Vision: Live the life. Tell the story.

Live the Life speaks to the internal work of God's Holy Spirit in the hearts and lives of God's Children. Do you not know that you are God's temple and that God's Spirit dwells in you? - *1 Corinthians 3:16* (ESV)

Tell the story speaks to the external work - sometimes called "evangelism." God does a great work in the hearts of His Children, and we have been called to share the story of Jesus with every living creature.

DISCIPLESHIP PROCESS MODEL



WORSHIP

Whether you join us for a weekend service or a Tuesday prayer night, the initial stage of our process is centered on worship. Worship forms the core of our regular gatherings, whether it's our two Sunday morning services or our Tuesday evening prayer session. During our weekend gatherings, we participate in worship, partake in monthly communion, and engage in Bible teaching that caters to both those who are curious about Christianity and those who have been longtime believers.

Additionally, throughout the year, we organize special Worship Nights aimed at involving our community and extending a warm invitation to visit our church. While your journey with us begins with worship, we strongly encourage you to take further steps towards becoming more deeply connected within our church community.

NEXT

Following your attendance at our weekend services, you might find yourself curious about our church—our beliefs, the roles of our team members, and our journey. That's why, on the **LAST Monday** of each month, we organize a dedicated class tailored for newcomers like yourself to delve deeper into who we call NEXT NIGHT.

During this one evening session, our team will guide you through a campus tour, providing insights into the various ministry opportunities available. You'll also have the chance to hear first-hand testimonies from our pastor and team members, gaining an understanding of our church's history and vision. Additionally, we'll allocate time for you to ask any questions you may have and to connect with our team members on a personal level.

LEARN

We strongly encourage you to prioritize your personal growth in your relationship with God. To assist you on this journey, we have developed two courses tailored to help you become a disciple of Jesus.

The first course, **ESSENTIALS,** is an 8-week program designed to impart foundational Christian beliefs. Through this course, you'll gain practical insights into why we hold certain beliefs and why we engage in specific practices at Garden City Church. Upon completion of Essentials, we offer another course called **TRUTH-TREK.** This ongoing annual program is crafted to deepen your understanding of God's Word, equipping you to effectively disciple others and fulfill the Great Commission. We trust that these courses will support and enrich your walk with Jesus.

Furthermore, during our Sunday **DISCIPLESHIP HOUR** we provide classes that foster fellowship and facilitate a closer sense of community. Additionally, we offer various specialized courses designed to address specific needs, such as grief support through our **GRIEF SHARE** program. We invite you to take advantage of these opportunities as you continue to grow in your faith journey.

LOVE

We believe LOVE is best demonstrated in community. We aim for you to connect with fellow Christ-followers and immerse yourself in community life. Striving to live out the Christian walk in isolation leaves us vulnerable to spiritual attack and susceptible to deception. Hence, we endeavor to cultivate an environment within our **CORE GROUPS** where genuine friendships and authentic fellowship thrive.

In our **CORE GROUPS**, we advocate for transparent living, offering a safe space for individuals to openly share their struggles, failures, and inconsistencies. These groups form the cornerstone of our church community, comprising members from diverse life stages and age groups. We firmly believe that everyone, regardless of age or marital status, has valuable insights to offer, and we can all learn from one another.

Our CORE Groups gather at various times throughout the week, and some even offer childcare services. With this flexibility, we are confident that you will find a CORE Group that aligns with your schedule and needs. Join us as we journey together in faith, supporting and uplifting one another along the way.

LEAD

We believe that leading in the church is synonymous with serving (Philippians 2:7). Engaging in service is fundamental to the life of every believer, and at our church, we offer numerous opportunities for involvement. Serving our church community comes in various forms, whether it's brewing coffee as part of our Hospitality Team, warmly welcoming and assisting guests through our Landing Team, or nurturing young minds in our children's ministry. Our ministries serve as places that are intended for you to not only participate, but to continue growing while partnering with others who are on their faith journeys.

Furthermore, we are continually exploring innovative ways to extend our service to the local community through initiatives such as Vacation Bible School and our Annual "Backpack Giveaway" event. Our commitment to missions goes beyond mere financial support; we maintain active connections with missionaries in the field through our growing missions department. We engage in missionary work both locally and globally, reaching out to different parts of the world with the message of Christ's love.

Through our acts of service, we embody Christ's love and effectively draw people closer to Him. This is how the gospel is shared and embraced within our community and beyond. We pray that you discover the perfect place for you to serve and make a meaningful impact.

DOCTRINES OF MAJOR & MINORS

WHAT IS A MAJOR?
A "major" within our belief system represents a doctrine or position that we consider fundamental to the historical understanding of Christianity. Examples of such majors include the exclusive nature of salvation through Jesus Christ, the inerrancy of Scripture, and the triune nature of God. These are non-negotiable principles, serving as foundational pillars on which the Church stands united and unwavering.

WHAT IS A MINOR?
A "minor" within our belief system refers to a doctrine or position that we uphold but do not consider essential enough to sever fellowship over. These are perspectives that we recognize as part of our faith tradition but do not deem crucial to the core understanding of Christianity. Examples of such minors include theological debates such as Calvinism versus Arminianism (predestination versus free will), variations in baptismal practices (for further explanation, please refer to page 8), and preferences regarding worship instrumentation.

While the Church remains unified on the majors, it acknowledges that not all Christians need to be in agreement on every minor issue. Put simply, we can respectfully disagree on minor points and still come together in worship and service, demonstrating unity amidst diversity (Titus 3:5–9).

WHY DEFINE MAJORS & MINORS?
In today's church landscape, divisions arise over numerous issues. While some matters warrant careful consideration, others are principles we must firmly uphold, and yet others call for outright opposition. By clearly articulating our positions and stances on various matters, we can foster unity and provide clarity. Scripture advises against engaging in pointless quarrels over every minor issue (2 Timothy 2:14). While certain doctrines merit thoughtful reflection and discussion, others serve as distractions from the central mission of Christ.

THE MAJORS

**This list is not exhaustive, but it gives you an idea of what some majors are.*

THE SCRIPTURES ARE TRUSTWORTHY
The Bible stands as God's unique revelation to humanity. It is the inspired Word of God, serving as the authoritative and dependable guide for faith and practice (John 17:17; 2 Timothy 3:16-17; 1 Peter 1:24-25; Revelation 22:18-19).

ONE GOD, THREE PERSONS
God exists eternally as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, comprising one divine being (Matthew 28:18-20; Matthew 3:16-17).

JESUS, OUR SAVIOR AND KING
Jesus Christ, the Son of God, was born of the Virgin Mary. He lived a sinless life, willingly bore all humanity's sins, died, and bodily rose again. He now sits at the right hand of the Father and will return to fulfill God's eternal plan (John 3:16; Romans 5:8; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Matthew 21:1-11; Revelation 19:11-16).

SALVATION IS A GIFT
Humanity's need for salvation arises from sin, which cannot be overcome through personal goodness or human effort. Salvation is a gift received through humble repentance and faith in Christ's finished work on the cross (Romans 6:23; Ephesians 2:8-9).

MEMBERS OF THE BODY:
All believers are integral parts of the Body of Christ, constituting the universal Church. Therefore, we do not practice local church membership (1 Corinthians 12:12-27).

Faith without Works is Dead: While salvation is not earned through works, genuine faith naturally produces good works as evidence. Faith and works are intertwined, demonstrating the authenticity of salvation (James 2:14–17; Ephesians 2:10).

SPIRIT EMPOWERMENT
We believe in the tangible presence of God through the Holy Spirit, bringing radical transformation to those who receive Jesus into their lives and the demonstration of all spiritual gifts. (Matthew 28:20; John 1:12; John 16:13).

PRAYER
Prayer is indispensable for believers and vital for deepening Christian spirituality. Following the pattern set forth in 2 Chronicles 7:14, prayer serves as the primary means through which God connects and communicates with His people (2 Chronicles 7:14).

1 For further info on our fundamental beliefs visit: https://ag.org/Beliefs/Statement-of-Fundamental-Truths

THE MINORS

**This list is not exhaustive, but it gives you an idea of what some minors are.*

ESCHATOLOGY:

There are various beliefs about how Christ will return, including pre-tribulation, mid-tribulation, and post-tribulation rapture. However, debating the specifics of Christ's return is akin to arguing about the exact color and physics of a staircase—it's not essential. What matters is that, like a staircase, Christ's return will fulfill its purpose if we faithfully do our part.

ETERNAL SECURITY VS. CONDITIONAL SECURITY

Some Christian circles teach that salvation can be lost, while others argue that it is eternally secure. Both views are considered serious errors according to passages like Galatians 3:1–3 and Hebrews 10:26. It's evident from the Bible that many claim to have secure salvation but lack a genuine relationship with Christ. Whether salvation was lost along life's journey or was never present, the crucial point is that if we faithfully follow Christ and demonstrate a genuine connection with God, our salvation remains secure.

CALVINISM VS. ARMINIANISM:

Calvinism and Arminianism are theological systems that aim to explain the balance between God's sovereignty and human responsibility in salvation. While studying these systems can be enlightening, arguing over them is not productive. The Bible, rather than human-made theological theories, should be our primary reference point in understanding these matters.

5-FOLD MINISTRY:

The 5-fold ministry, as outlined in Ephesians 4:11-13, encompasses distinct roles within the church: apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers. These roles serve essential functions in equipping and edifying the body of Christ. While there may be debates regarding the validity and continuation of these offices or the use of specific titles within certain circles, it's important to recognize that our focus should ultimately be on serving the Lord Jesus and fulfilling our individual roles within the church. We believe in the continuity of these gifts and the significance of these offices, but we also prioritize unity and cooperation rather than allowing disagreements over terminology or structure to become stumbling blocks in our collective mission.

"OTHER" DENOMINATIONS & MINISTERS' TEACHINGS:

As believers, we adhere to the principle of refraining from criticizing other ministries, pastors, or leaders. While we acknowledge the importance of addressing corruption and mishandling of God's Word when necessary, we exercise caution in doing so. We recognize that our primary responsibility is to maintain integrity in our own actions and teachings, rather than engaging in unnecessary criticism of others. The Bible instructs us not to judge another man's servant (Romans 14:4), emphasizing the importance of humility and respect in our interactions with fellow believers and their ministries.

Therefore, if we find ourselves in disagreement with the methods or teachings of another ministry or denomination, our response is rooted in prayer rather than fostering contention, gossip, or criticism. We understand that we may not personally know the leaders or have a relationship with the communities being criticized, which further emphasizes the need for discernment and humility in our approach. Instead of focusing on differences, we prioritize unity within the body of Christ and extend grace to those with whom we may disagree. In essence, while we remain vigilant in upholding the truth and integrity of God's Word, we do so with a spirit of love, humility, and prayer, recognizing that our ultimate goal is to glorify God and build up His kingdom rather than tearing down others.

DOCTRINE REGARDING BAPTISM

Baptism:
We believe the Bible clearly teaches that baptism is an outward expression of an inward conviction - a decision rooted in obedience to Jesus. Baptism serves as a symbolic public declaration of our decision to follow Christ. Much like a wedding ring symbolizes marriage, baptism represents our commitment to Christ. However, just as a ring does not create a marriage, baptism alone does not secure our salvation. Unless preceded by genuine repentance (Matthew 3:8) and followed by a life of discipleship demonstrating true faith (James 2:17), baptism holds no significance.

Purpose of Baptism:
In essence, we baptize because Jesus instructed us to do so. In His final instructions to His disciples, Jesus commanded the baptism of all nations (Matthew 28:19). He not only gave this command but also led by example, being baptized Himself (Matthew 3:13–17). Despite having no need for repentance due to His sinless life, Jesus chose baptism as a demonstration of obedience to God the Father (Matthew 3:17). As followers of Christ, who strive to emulate His example, we obey His command by undergoing baptism.

Does Jesus Require Baptism?
This question is misguided. Instead of focusing on the minimum requirement for salvation, we should recognize the gravity of sin and the magnitude of grace. Rather than asking what we must do for God, we should inquire about what we can do for Him.

Baptism by Immersion:
We believe in baptizing individuals who have repented of their sins and wish to publicly declare their faith in Jesus Christ through full-immersion baptism. However, we do not view baptism as possessing magical powers. No individual can grant or revoke salvation through the act of baptism (Romans 8:38–39).

If you have undergone a previous baptism that did not meet the aforementioned criteria, such as sprinkling or infant baptism without full comprehension, you may consider undergoing re-baptism. Nonetheless, genuine baptism need only occur once. If seeking forgiveness for sins committed post-baptism, sincere repentance and seeking forgiveness from God suffice.

DOCTRINE REGARDING COMMUNION

Communion:
Communion is a symbolic practice, serving as a reminder of Christ's death and sacrifice on the cross, resurrection and promised return. It utilizes bread to symbolize Jesus' body and the cup to symbolize His blood (Matthew 26, Mark 14, Luke 22, 1 Corinthians 11).

Purpose of Communion:
All followers of Jesus are welcome to participate in communion after self-examination. Paul's warning in 1 Corinthians 11:27 about taking communion "in an unworthy manner" underscores the importance of understanding its significance. Proper respect and reverence entails respectfully reflecting on the elements that represents Jesus' body and the purpose of remembering His death and sacrifice (1 Corinthians 11:29).

Communion at Garden City Church:
Communion is available the first Sunday of every month during ‘Family Sundays.’ We invite families to receive communion with one another. During this time, we encourage all believers to reflect on their lives and seek forgiveness. Respect for the solemnity of the occasion is encouraged, recognizing its profound significance in human history.

DOCTRINE REGARDING SEXUALITY

We are officially a 'Welcoming-Non Affirming' community.

We believe that God created all men and women in His image, but sin leads humanity to rebel against God and His Word, including in the area of human sexuality. At Garden City Church, we welcome all who struggle with sin, including sexual sin, and guide them toward repentance and faith in Jesus Christ as Lord and Savior.

Marriage:

Marriage is a covenant relationship created by God, intended to be between one man and one woman until death separates them. Anything outside of this God- given institution is considered sin and not validated by God.

LGBTQ+:

To those grappling with promiscuity, same-sex attraction, or gender dysphoria, we direct them to the transforming power of God to lead us to holiness in conformity to His Son's image. While we embrace all who struggle with sin, we do not affirm anything contrary to God's Word. We believe Gods word teaches us that we can meet God exactly as we are, but his love will transform us.

If you are in a same-sex relationship or marriage, you and your family are wholeheartedly welcome. While we are a welcoming - non-affirming" church, we greet, love, and respect all individuals without exception. Our teaching is rooted in the entirety of the Bible, which includes upholding the sacred union of one man and one woman in marriage.

Concerning same-sex marriages, we believe in honoring the sacred covenant established by God, which requires compliance with His terms. Marriage, as defined by God, is a covenant between Him, one man, and one woman. We invite you to explore God's love and His desire for a personal relationship with you, regardless of your current circumstances. We would love to walk with you on your Spiritual Journey.

DOCTRINE REGARDING INTOXICATION

We believe in adhering strictly to the biblical injunction to be controlled by the Holy Spirit in both our thoughts and behaviors. While some theological positions may advocate for the permissibility of alcohol consumption, we recognize the pervasive societal struggle with alcoholism and addiction. In light of this, we maintain our stance against all forms of alcohol consumption primarily with our Pastoral Team, Staff and Board Members.

While acknowledging differing interpretations, we firmly believe that a life of sobriety is overwhelmingly advocated for in the Bible - especially for the betterment and example of those in our community who have come out of a life of addiction and abuse.

We believe that embracing sobriety aligns us more closely with the teachings of Jesus Christ and enables us to better fulfill our mission to serve and support one another in faith.

CHURCH STRUCTURE:

1. SNEMN - Southern New England Ministry Network
Garden City Church operates within the Southern New England Ministry Network (SNEMN) as a cooperative fellowship of the Assemblies of God. The church functions under the district leadership of Superintendent Nick Fatato.

2. LEAD PASTOR
Aaron Rios serves as the Lead Pastor of Garden City Church. He provides the overarching mission and vision that guides every aspect of the organization.

3. BOARD
The Board of Garden City Church comprises District Appointed officials responsible for overseeing finances and ensuring church operations align with the core tenets of the Assemblies of God Fellowship.

4. ASSOCIATES
Associate Pastors are leaders selected by the Lead Pastor to assist with co-pastoring duties, particularly concerning the spiritual health and vitality of the community.

THE ROLE OF WOMEN IN MINISTRY:

Garden City Church affirms the giftedness of both men and women for ministry. We believe in the biblical principle that ministry and leadership roles are appointed to individuals based on their callings and obedience to God, regardless of gender. This includes recognizing and supporting women in various ministry capacities within the church community.

MUSIC AND SERVICE FLOW:

we strive to create an environment aligned with the activities and approval of the Holy Spirit. Our music selection is contemporary and thoughtfully curated to create a worshipful-Holy Spirit enriched environment. Our primary goal is to ensure that everyone who enters feels welcomed and encounters the genuine presence and power of the Holy Spirit. We view music and service flow as integral to pointing towards the ministry of the Word and at all times keeping Jesus front and center. Sunday services are intentionally designed to be evangelistic in nature, ensuring that first-time guests feel included and valued. We recognize that not everyone attending a service may already be saved, and we aim to reach out to all individuals, regardless of their background or experiences. We are mindful that attendees may come from diverse situations, including those who might be experiencing desperation, such as spending the weekend on a drug binge or encountering a traumatic situation. Our commitment is to honor and welcome all individuals equally, showing them the same respect and compassion.

OUR 16 FUNDAMENTAL TRUTHS

Statement of Fundamental Truths is the official delineation of the Assemblies of God's 16 doctrines. These truths are non-negotiable beliefs that all Assemblies of God churches adhere to.

1. THE SCRIPTURES INSPIRED

The Scriptures, both Old and New Testaments, are verbally inspired of God and are the revelation of God to man, the infallible, authoritative rule of faith and conduct (2 Timothy 3:15-17; 1 Thessalonians 2:13; 2 Peter 1:21).

2. THE ONE TRUE GOD

The one true God has revealed himself as the eternally self-existent "I AM," the Creator of heaven and earth and the Redeemer of mankind. He has further revealed himself as embodying the principles of relationship and association as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit (Deuteronomy 6:4; Isaiah 43:10,11; Matthew 28:19; Luke 3:22).

3. THE DEITY OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST

The Lord Jesus Christ is the eternal Son of God. The Scriptures declare:
a. His virgin birth (Matthew 1:23; Luke 1:31,35).
b. His sinless life (Hebrews 7:26; 1 Peter 2:22).
c. His miracles (Acts 2:22; 10:38).
d. His substitutionary work on the cross (1 Corinthians 15:3; 2 Corinthians 5:21).
e. His bodily resurrection from the dead (Matthew 28:6; Luke 24:39; 1 Corinthians 15:4).
f. His exaltation to the right hand of God (Acts 1:9,11; 2:33; Philippians 2:9-11; Hebrews 1:3).

4. THE FALL OF MAN

Man was created good and upright; for God said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness." However, man by voluntary transgression fell and thereby incurred not only physical death but also spiritual death, which is separation from God (Genesis 1:26,27; 2:17; 3:6; Romans 5:12-19).

5. THE SALVATION OF MAN

Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ the Son of God.

(a) Conditions to Salvation

Salvation is received through repentance toward God and faith toward the Lord Jesus Christ. By the washing of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Spirit, being justified by grace through faith, man becomes an heir of God according to the hope of eternal life (Luke 24:47; John 3:3; Romans 10:13-15; Ephesians 2:8; Titus 2:11; 3:5-7).

(b) The Evidences of Salvation

The inward evidence of salvation is the direct witness of the Spirit (Romans 8:16). The outward evidence to all men is a life of righteousness and true holiness (Ephesians 4:24; Titus 2:12).

OUR 16 FUNDAMENTAL TRUTHS

6. THE ORDINANCES OF THE CHURCH

(a) Baptism in Water

The ordinance of baptism by immersion is commanded in the Scriptures. All who repent and believe on Christ as Savior and Lord are to be baptized. Thus they declare to the world that they have died with Christ and that they also have been raised with Him to walk in newness of life (Matthew 28:19; Mark 16:16; Acts 10:47,48; Romans 6:4).

(b) Holy Communion

The Lord's Supper, consisting of the elements—bread and the fruit of the vine—is the symbol expressing our sharing the divine nature of our Lord Jesus Christ (2 Peter 1:4); a memorial of His suffering and death (1 Corinthians 11:26); and a prophecy of His second coming (1 Corinthians 11:26); and is enjoined on all believers "till He come!"

7. THE BAPTISM IN THE HOLY SPIRIT

All believers are entitled to and should ardently expect and earnestly seek the promise of the Father, the baptism in the Holy Spirit and fire, according to the command of our Lord Jesus Christ. This was the normal experience of all in the early Christian church. With it comes the enduement of power for life and service, the bestowment of the gifts and their uses in the work of the ministry (Luke 24:49; Acts 1:4,8; 1 Corinthians 12:1-31). This experience is distinct from and subsequent to the experience of the new birth (Acts 8:12-17; 10:44-46; 11:14-16; 15:7-9). With the baptism in the Holy Spirit come such experiences as an overflowing fullness of the Spirit (John 7:37-39; Acts 4:8), a deepened reverence for God (Acts 2:43; Hebrews 12:28), an intensified consecration to God and dedication to His work (Acts 2:42), and a more active love for Christ, for His Word, and for the lost (Mark 16:20).

8. THE INITIAL PHYSICAL EVIDENCE OF THE BAPTISM IN THE HOLY SPIRIT

The baptism of believers in the Holy Spirit is witnessed by the initial physical sign of speaking with other tongues as the Spirit of God gives them utterance (Acts 2:4). The speaking in tongues in this instance is the same in essence as the gift of tongues (1 Corinthians 12:4-10,28), but different in purpose and use.

9. SANCTIFICATION

Sanctification is an act of separation from that which is evil, and of dedication unto God (Romans 12:1,2; 1 Thessalonians 5:23; Hebrews 13:12). Scriptures teach a life of "holiness without which no man shall see the Lord" (Hebrews 12:14). By the power of the Holy Spirit we are able to obey the command: "Be ye holy, for I am holy" (1 Peter 1:15,16). Sanctification is realized in the believer by recognizing his identification with Christ in His death and resurrection, and by faith reckoning daily upon the fact of that union, and by offering every faculty continually to the dominion of the Holy Spirit (Romans 6:1-11,13; 8:1,2,13; Galatians 2:20; Philippians 2:12,13; 1 Peter 1:5).

10. THE CHURCH AND ITS MISSION

The Church is the body of Christ, the habitation of God through the Spirit, with divine appointments for the fulfillment of her Great Commission. Each believer, born of the Spirit, is an integral part of the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven (Ephesians 1:22,23; 2:22; Hebrews 12:23).

11. THE MINISTRY

A divinely called and scripturally ordained ministry has been provided by our Lord for the fourfold purpose of leading the Church in: (1) evangelization of the world (Mark 16:15-20), (2) worship of God (John 4:23,24), (3) building a Body of saints being perfected in the image of His Son (Ephesians 4:11,16), and (4) Meeting human need with ministries of love and compassion (Psalms 112:9; Galatians 2:10; 6:10; James 1:27).

12. DIVINE HEALING

Divine healing is an integral part of the gospel. Deliverance from sickness is provided for in the Atonement, and is the privilege of all believers (Isaiah 53:4,5; Matthew 8:16,17; James 5:14-16).

13. THE BLESSED HOPE

The resurrection of those who have fallen asleep in Christ and their translation together with those who are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord is the imminent and blessed hope of the Church (1 Thessalonians 4:16,17; Romans 8:23; Titus 2:13; 1 Corinthians 15:51,52).

14. THE MILLENNIAL REIGN OF CHRIST

The second coming of Christ includes the rapture of the saints, which is our blessed hope, followed by the visible return of Christ with His saints to reign on the earth for one thousand years (Zechariah 14:5; Matthew 24:27,30; Revelation 1:7; 19:11-14; 20:1-6). This millennial reign will bring the salvation of national Israel (Ezekiel 37:21,22; Zephaniah 3:19,20; Romans 11:26,27) and the establishment of universal peace (Isaiah 11:6-9; Psalm 72:3-8; Micah 4:3,4).

15. THE FINAL JUDGMENT

There will be a final judgment in which the wicked dead will be raised and judged according to their works. Whosoever is not found written in the Book of Life, together with the devil and his angels, the beast and the false prophet, will be consigned to everlasting punishment in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone, which is the second death (Matthew 25:46; Mark 9:43-48; Revelation 19:20; 20:11-15; 21:8).

16. THE NEW HEAVENS AND THE NEW EARTH

“We, according to His promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness”
(2 Peter 3:13; Revelation 21,22).